

Pamela Dale- Rourke

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PROFILE

Dedicated and creative Play Therapist with a profound commitment to facilitating communication and emotional expression in children. Experienced in developing tailored therapeutic resources that enhance the psychological well-being of young individuals. Proven track record of collaboration with families and educational staff to create meaningful interventions that address diverse needs. Skilled in adapting communication strategies to ensure accessibility and engagement, while fostering a supportive environment for children to thrive. My personal experience with AAC users enriches my understanding and approach to therapy.

EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire

SKILLS

Understanding of inclusive communication

SEN

and speech and language therapy.

Strong digital skills for resource creation

layout

and design.

Collaboration with therapists

educators

and families to ensure resources meet user needs.

Mind Express 5

Widgit Online).

Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS

SymbolStix

Widgit

Bliss

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind, Manchester | October 2016 - Present

- Designed and adapted a wide range of communication and therapy resources to effectively support children's diverse needs within schools, including visual supports and symbol-based activities.
- Provided impactful 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy, specializing in psychotherapeutic assessments that guide comprehensive therapeutic pathways for children.
- Collaborated closely with teachers and therapists to develop accessible and engaging materials tailored for children with communication and learning challenges, enhancing their educational experience.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, delivering training in resource utilization and inclusive communication strategies to promote best practices.
- Coordinated workshops for parents and educators, fostering a deeper understanding of child behavior and effective communication techniques to support children's emotional development.
- Evaluated and refined therapy programs based on feedback and outcomes, ensuring continuous improvement in service delivery for children and families.

Play Therapist | Barnardos, St Helens | January 2015 - October 2016

- Created individualized visual and therapeutic resources for children referred through CAMHS, ensuring each resource was tailored to meet specific needs and preferences.
- Participated actively in assessment meetings, providing recommendations for appropriate communication supports and interventions based on detailed evaluations.
- Managed a diverse caseload of school-aged children, employing creative and resource-based approaches to effectively address a wide range of social, emotional, and communication challenges.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions for colleagues, sharing best practices and strategies on child-centered communication to enhance therapeutic outcomes.
- Engaged in regular professional development activities to stay updated on the latest research and methodologies in child psychology and therapy.
- Documented progress and outcomes meticulously, allowing for data-driven adjustments to therapy plans to better serve children's evolving needs.

Family Session Worker | OJs, Preston | May 2023 - January 2024

- Supported families with children on the autism spectrum, designing and adapting resources that facilitate engagement and effective communication in therapeutic settings.
- Developed inclusive activities that ensured children with communication differences could participate meaningfully in group settings, promoting social skills and self-expression.
- Collaborated with families and interdisciplinary teams to assess individual needs and develop practical, user-friendly resources that enhance therapeutic outcomes.
- Conducted workshops to educate parents on communication strategies and behavioral support techniques, empowering them to reinforce therapy goals at home.
- Regularly evaluated the effectiveness of resources and activities, making adjustments based on feedback from families and children to maximize engagement.
- Maintained strong communication with all stakeholders to ensure a cohesive approach to the therapy process, fostering trust and collaboration.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school | N/A

- Planned and developed comprehensive literacy and learning resources for primary-aged children, ensuring alignment with educational objectives and best practices.
- Created engaging classroom materials that supported reading and writing development, making learning accessible and enjoyable for children with diverse needs.
- Collaborated closely with teachers to align resources with lesson objectives, promoting an integrated approach to learning and

HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Writing



Meditation



Art

development.

- Adapted activities to suit various learning styles and levels, ensuring inclusivity and engagement for all students.
- Conducted assessments of resource effectiveness, utilizing feedback to refine and improve educational materials continuously.
- Engaged in collaborative planning sessions with educational staff to foster a unified approach to student engagement and support.

CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care (Preston College)

Play Therapy (Canterbury Christ University)

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy (Manchester)